# İpek Ece Şener

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## Appointment

2026– **Western University**
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science

2024–2026 **Harvard University**
College Fellow, Department of Government

## Education

2018–2024 **Washington University in St. Louis**
Ph.D. in Political Science

2016–2018 **Sabancı University**
M.A. in Political Science

2011–2016 **Boğaziçi University**
B.A. in Political Science and International Relations

2015 **Institut d'Études Politiques de Paris (Sciences Po Paris)**
Erasmus+

## Research Interests

International relations, political violence, quantitative research methodology.

## Publications

[5] William G. Nomikos, İpek Ece Şener and Rob Williams. **The Peacekeeping Dilemma: Understanding the Challenges of UN Peacekeeping in Modern Conflicts**, *World Politics*, Forthcoming.

[4] David Carter and İpek Ece Şener. **Strike When They Aren't Looking: Great Power Crises and Threats to Rule**, *Journal of Peace Research*, Online First.

[3] İpek Ece Şener (2025). **Peace Negotiations and Civilian Targeting**, *Journal of Conflict Resolution.* 69(9): 1580-1607.

[2] Afiq bin Oslan and İpek Ece Şener (2025). **Displacement, not Obstruction: Why Insecure Leaders Need Not Fear Free Media**, *Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy.* 6(2): 135-160.

[1] Peter Kalulu, Aubrey Fisher, Grace Whitter, İpek Ece Şener, Michelle Doering, David Carter, Matthew Gabel, Jimin Ding, Michael Esposito, Caitlin McMurtry, Pradeep Sopory and Mark Huffman (2025). **Trust, Trust Repair, and Public Health: A Scoping Review**, *Frontiers in Public Health.* 13:1560089

## Under Review

**Let Activists Protest and Speak: How Peaceful Actors Curb Militant Support**

**Beyond Court Composition: How Sitting Judges Adapt to Court Expansion**, *R&R*

**How Foreign Policy Crisis Shapes Public Opinion on Social Media**
(with Amaan Charaniya, Rex Deng, Jin Kim, Gechun Lin, William G. Nomikos)
APSA Foreign Policy Division Best Paper Award

## Selected Working Papers

**Peacetime Ideology, Wartime Agitation: How Militants Tailor Propaganda to Conflict Intensity**

**Smaller-State Agency in Great-Power Competition for Influence**
(with Afiq bin Oslan)

**Trust on Trial: Measuring Trust in Government through Public Health Court Cases**
(with Scott Abramson, David Carter, and Dot Sawler)

## Skills

Software R, Python, Stata, SPSS, LaTeX.

Language Turkish (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Arabic (reading)

## Grants and Awards

2023 **Conflict Processes Section Travel Award**, *American Political Science Association*, $150

2023 **PolMeth Conference Attendance Support**, *National Science Foundation*, $1600

2022 **Global Studies Small Research Grant**, *Global Studies, WUSTL*, $2000

2022 **First Generation Scholars in the Profession Travel and Accessibility Grant**, *American Political Science Association*, $200

2022 **Travel Grant**, *American Political Science Association*, $150

2021 **Research Grant**, *Weidenbaum Center, WUSTL*, $10,000

2021 **Research Seed Grant**, *Department of Political Science, WUSTL*, $3,000

2018 **McDonnell International Scholars Academy Ph.D. Scholarship**, *WUSTL*, Full Tuition, Monthly Stipend, Travel Allowance

2017 **Full Scholarship**, *Sabancı University*, Full Tuition, Accommodation, Monthly Stipend

## Invited Talks

2026 **Georgetown University in Qatar**, *Doha*

2025 **University of Florida**, *Gainesville, FL*

2025 **New York University Abu Dhabi**, *Abu Dhabi*

2025 **Cornell University**, *Ithaca, NY*

2025 **Trinity College Dublin**, *Dublin*

2024 **University of Michigan**, *Ann Arbor, MI*

2024 **Max Planck Institute for Tax Law and Public Finance**, *Munich*

2023 **Bilkent University**, *Ankara*

2023 **Kadir Has University**, *Istanbul*

2023 **University of Strathclyde**, *Glasgow*

## Teaching Experience

2026 **Instructor**, *Poli Sci 3329: Politics of the Middle East*, Western University

2025 **Instructor**, *GOV 1705: Politics of War and Peace in the Middle East*, Harvard University

2024 **Instructor**, *GOV 94IS: Democracy and Authoritarianism in the Middle East*, Harvard University

2021&2023 **Teaching Assistant**, *Pol Sci 102: Introduction to Comparative Politics*, WUSTL.

2022 **Teaching Assistant**, *Pol Sci 317: Conflict and Security in International Relations*, WUSTL

2021 **Teaching Assistant**, *Pol Sci 337: Climate Change and Conflict*, WUSTL.

2020 **Teaching Assistant**, *Pol Sci 339: Political Violence*, WUSTL.

2019 **Teaching Assistant**, *Pol Sci 505: Theories of Individual and Collective Choice I*, WUSTL.

2016-2018 **Teaching Assistant**, *SPS303: Law and Ethics*, Sabancı University.

2017 **Facilitator**, *GR501: Academic Practices and Development*, Sabancı University.

2016 **Teaching Assistant**, *POLS202: History of the Political Thought*, Boğaziçi University.

## Conference and Workshop Attendance

2026 **European Political Science Society**, *Annual Meeting*, June 18-20, Belfast, UK

2025 **Empirical Studies of Conflict**, *Annual Meeting*, October 9-10, Washington D.C.

2025 **APSA Annual Meeting & Exhibition**, September 11-14, Vancouver, BC, Canada

2024 **Peace Science Society International**, *Annual Meeting*, November 7-9, Ann Arbor, MI

2024 **Empirical Studies of Conflict**, *Annual Meeting*, October 18-19, Los Angelos, CA

2023 **Peace Science Society International**, *Annual Meeting*, November 9-11, St. Louis, MO

2023 **APSA Annual Meeting & Exhibition**, August 31-September 3, Los Angelos, CA

2023 **Society for Political Methodology**, *Annual Meeting*, July 9-11, Palo Alto, CA

2022 **Peace Science Society International**, *Annual Meeting*, November 3-5, Denver, CO

2022 **Bridging the Gap**, *New Era Workshop*, October 7-9, Denver, CO

2022 **APSA Annual Meeting & Exhibition**, *September 15-18*, Montreal, Québec, Canada

2022 **APSA MENA Conference**, July 28-30, Amman, Jordan

2022 **ISA Annual Convention**, March 28-April 2, Nashville, TN

2021 **ISA Midwest**, *Annual Regional Conference*, November 19-21, St. Louis, MO

2021 **Peace Science Society International**, *Anual Meeting*, November 19-20, Online